

01-23-2024 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8NTbXltD8Zc
Publication Date	2024-01-24T11:06:54Z
Target Category	mcs

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Muncie Community Schools Board of Education Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: (Not explicitly stated in transcript; referenced as Board Appreciation Month / January)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting was called to order by the presiding officer (00:05:28), opening with the Pledge of Allegiance. The presiding officer noted that it was a “foggy night” and requested to move through the agenda with expedition.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Board members including Mr. Low, Spence Griffin, Mr. Orr, and other members participating in discussions.
 - **Absent:** Mr. Peter (noted as out of the country).
 - **Presiding Officer:** Mr. Williams (implied by references to “Mr. Williams” managing the agenda/meeting).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance (00:05:47).
 - **Approval of Minutes:** Prior meeting minutes disposition was not explicitly detailed, though procedural consent items were processed.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:06:21 South View Elementary School Presentation & Report**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Casey (Principal) and Miss Davis (Assistant Principal), accompanied by staff members and students (including Javante, CeCe, Ka, and the therapy dog, Merlin).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Administrators presented glowing academic and behavioral data for South View Elementary. Highlights included:
 - Kindergarten literacy growth: 61% of students (43 students) are now on grade level (up from 13% at the start of the year).
 - High quadrants of growth across elementary schools.
 - Decreased percentages of students scoring two or more grade levels behind.
 - Increased student and teacher attendance driven by expanded field trips (to the Children's Museum, Indianapolis Zoo, Conor Prairie, and Ivy Tech), spirit weeks, and incentives ("attendance wars").
 - Implementation of "Writing Cafe" to build writing stamina and targeted reading interventions.
 - Student speakers shared personal academic improvements, favorite field trips, and constructive suggestions (such as adding a No Bullying policy, more sports/extracurriculars, updated gym activities like roller skating, and snack booths for families in need).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation only; no formal board vote required. Board members expressed deep appreciation and praise for the administration and students.
- **00:35:57 Consent Agenda & Retirements**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Presiding Officer / Superintendent.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board recognized two retiring staff members, Tamara Bell and Natalia Lewis, who combined have given 55 years of service to Muncie Community Schools (MCS).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote. *(Note: Procedurally returned to after a brief interruption for Board Appreciation Month).*
- **00:36:45 Superintendent & Administrative Updates (Board Appreciation Month)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. K (Superintendent) & Board Members.
 - **Deliberation Summary:**

- Recognized January as Board Appreciation Month, thanking the board for their selfless dedication.
 - Highlighted a recent Lily endowment event at Grissom Elementary featuring family navigators and literacy coaches.
 - Noted upcoming events including the Westview ribbon cutting (January 30th), a process check at Grissom, and a Ball State University (BSU) faculty convening.
 - Celebrated athletic achievements: Southside Middle School won the 7th-grade basketball championship, and Northside Middle School won the 8th-grade basketball championship.
 - Discussed the formation of the Muncie Community School Education Foundation as a separate 501(c)(3) entity.
- **00:41:16 Addition of Action Item: Muncie Community School Education Foundation Director Liaison**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. K / Board Leadership.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Proposed adding an action item to officially approve assigning Dia as the Director Liaison to the newly formed Muncie Community School Education Foundation.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote to add to the agenda; subsequently Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:43:03 Employee Handbook Updates**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** District Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented updates to the MCS Employee Handbook, which covers teachers, support staff, and administrators. Key updates include:
 - Addition of employee ethics policy (page 10).
 - Extension of 2-hour delay office staff definitions to include student assistant coordinators and family navigators.
 - Addition of restrictions regarding taking off the day prior to or after Memorial Day.
 - Flexing bereavement leave windows from 7 business days to a 30-day period requiring special approval by the CEO/designee in special circumstances.
 - Compliance updates for FMLA and alcohol/substance control policies (page 38).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (Motion by Mr. Orr, Second by Spence Griffin).
- **00:47:03 Middle School Course of Study Handbook**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** District Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Outlined minor updates to the middle school course guide, including:
 - Making "Planning for College and Career" a mandatory credit requirement in middle school.

- Adding Spanish II for dual-language students earning high school credit.
 - Adding Biology I and II for high school credit in middle school.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
 - **00:50:36 High School Curriculum Handbook**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** District Administration / Caleb and team.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented high school curriculum updates, featuring:
 - A new "English as a New Language" course for newcomer students.
 - A new Career and Technical Education (CTE) pathway focused on HVAC certification.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

No open public comment period involving external community members unassociated with the scheduled school presentations took place during this portion of the meeting.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Countywide safety commission updates regarding statutory safety committees and upcoming active shooter subcommittees.
 - Announcement of the **State of the Schools Address** scheduled for **May 8th at 6:00 PM** at Southside Middle School.
 - Acknowledgment of MCS support for local Martin Luther King Jr. (MLK) events.
 - Future recognition plans for middle school academic and athletic champions, as well as robotics teams heading to the state competition.
 - **Adjournment:**
 - Motion to adjourn made and seconded.
 - **Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (**00:58:12**).
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